

June 26, 2026

Dr. Just Cebrian, Editor-in-Chief
Dr. Devyani Kar, Associate Editor
Estuaries and Coasts

Dear Dr. Cebrian and Dr. Kar,

Enclosed please find our revised manuscript, titled 'Managing the unmanageable: Understanding the competing effects of salinity and nutrient loading on estuarine water quality', to be considered as a management applications article in Estuaries and Coasts.

We sincerely appreciate the constructive comments provided by both reviewers. Our point-by-point responses document our revisions in detail. In brief, we have provided more substantial justification for our modeling approach (reviewer 1) and included additional work exploring alternative model structures (reviewer 2). Much of this content is included in the supplement to further justify our approach. Additional elaboration on our methods has also been provided at appropriate locations in the text. Overall, our conclusions remain the same and our intent is to motivate resource managers to look more proactively at existing management paradigms relative to shifting baselines.

Again, we greatly appreciate the opportunity to publish this work in Estuaries and Coasts and believe that readers will consider it a valuable contribution. Please feel free to contact us directly should additional information be needed.

Regards,

Dr. Marcus W. Beck
Tampa Bay Estuary Program
St. Petersburg, Florida, USA
mbeck@tbep.org